

Open Source Initiative names Stefano Maffulli as first executive director

The Open Source Initiative (OSI) has named Stefano Maffulli as its first executive director. The appointment is a key step for the transformation of OSI into a professionally managed organisation, a process that the board of directors started in 2020.



Joshua Simmons, board chair of OSI, said that bringing Stefano Maffulli on board as OSI's first executive director is the culmination of a year-long march towards professionalisation, so that OSI can be a stronger and more responsive advocate for open source.

Maffulli joins OSI after decades of open source advocacy, both as a contributor and leader. He co-founded and led the Italian chapter of Free Software Foundation Europe from 2001 to 2007. He has also structured the developer community of the OpenStack Foundation and led open source marketing teams in several international companies. He has contributed documentation patches, translations and advocated for projects as diverse as GNU, QGIS, OpenStreetmap and WordPress.

Maffulli added that open source software is everywhere, but its definition is constantly being challenged. The zombies of shared source, limited use and proprietary software are emerging from the graves where we put them to rest in the 90s, threatening the whole ecosystem, he added.

Elastic Cloud Terraform provider

Elastic has announced the general availability of the HashiCorp verified Elastic Cloud Terraform provider for users of HashiCorp Terraform to deploy and manage Elastic Cloud. HashiCorp Terraform is a tool that allows users to manage the entire life cycle of infrastructure using infrastructure as code.

Users can now apply the same automation code on Elastic Cloud deployments across all public clouds available in Elasticsearch Service on Elastic Cloud, or on premises using Elastic Cloud Enterprise. Elastic Cloud Terraform provider features include using Elastic stack deployments as code, with common source control tools and methodologies. It will also dynamically scale deployments to ensure performance and reliability, regardless of deployment topology or data tier configuration.

"We are excited to have Elastic as a technology partner and look forward to our future collaboration," said Asvin Ramesh, senior director, Alliances at HashiCorp. "With the new HashiCorp Terraform Verified provider for Elastic Cloud, our mutual users and customers can leverage the power of infrastructure as code to automate the provisioning and management of cloud deployments, by acting as a bridge to the Elasticsearch Service."

Acquia to acquire Widen

Acquia has announced that it will acquire Widen, a cloud native maker of digital asset management (DAM) and product information management (PIM) software. It said that this acquisition will merge digital assets such as rich media, product information and marketing copy in a single workflow, and provide an intuitive interface to democratise access for marketers to all of a brand's resources. Widen will enable marketers and website builders to create richer and more distinctive customer experiences using the



Acquia open digital experience platform (DXP).

The company added, "To create personalised customer engagement at scale, brands create immense volumes of digital content. Traditionally, the DAM simplifies marketers' access to this content, and manages versions and workflow

to ensure consistency. But within the context of a DXP, a modern DAM must also provide robust technical capabilities and extensibility. A PIM solution should enable enrichment of product data with marketing copy and digital assets to easily create branded product content. Together, these capabilities help organisations create and refine distinctive digital experiences based on evolving customer preferences."

Red Hat joins OS-Climate

Red Hat, Inc. has announced that it has joined OS-Climate (OS-C), a Linux Foundation-backed open source project that intends to build the breakthrough technology and data platforms needed to more fully integrate the impact of climate change in global financial decision-making and risk management. It will provide technical acumen and resources to help OS-C build a 'Data Commons' that serves as an open data ingestion, processing and management platform for members to collaborate on standardising and improving the accuracy of corporate climate and environmental, social and governance (ESG) metrics.